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While this project does not deal with a particularly contentious topic, there have still been a few ethical issues encountered as it progresses. Most notably, a key portion of the analysis involves feature engineering a “talent” score for certain cast and crew of each film in the dataset. Although not dealing with private or sensitive personal information, the process to assigning a numeric value to these people and their artistic value can be problematic. In particular, traditional awards such as the Oscars have historically been given to people of specific demographics, while the Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences also includes individuals from the business community with ulterior motives. Thus, including whether or not a cast or crew member has won any of these awards in the calculation of a “talent” score involves accepting the awards granted by flawed system as unbiased. A method currently under consideration that might partially offset this problem is granting greater weight to peer-voted prizes like the SAG awards, for which winning is influenced purely by the artistic community and not by campaign promotions, commercial voices, and other factors with a disengenous agenda. At the same time, though, there is also a more general problem with reducing people to a single number and an input into a model. Though the metric developed in this paper might work in terms of its ability to predict box office performance, it will almost certainly not fairly reflect the true “value” of a person’s contribution to a project. This problem is one that exists amongst any analysis that ranks individuals in such a fashion and cannot be fully addressed without changing this project altogether. Nonetheless, it will be important to make clear that the “scores” tabulated are merely proxy’s based on factors believed to have box-office draw and not genuine talent or worth.